

UNIT 02- SPEAKING

1. Speaking Modes

Speaking mode refers to the manner or style in which we speak depending on the situation, audience, and purpose. It can range from formal speeches to casual conversations, and each mode requires a different tone, vocabulary, and structure.

Types of Modes:

1. **Formal Mode:** Giving a speech at a college / official function.
2. **Informal Mode:** Chatting with friends in the canteen.
3. **Academic Mode:** Presenting research in a seminar.
4. **Persuasive Mode:** Convincing the classmates to support your idea for a social / national cause.
5. **Narrative Mode:** Sharing a personal experience in storytelling format.
6. **Extempore:** Speaking spontaneously on a given topic with some preparation time.
7. **Impromptu:** Speaking immediately without any preparation or notice.
8. **Reading:** Delivering a speech by reading a written text aloud.
9. **Memorizing:** Reciting a speech from memory without referring to notes.
10. **Drill:** Practicing repetitive speaking exercises to improve fluency and accuracy.

2. Non-Verbal Features:

Non-verbal cues are body language signals like gestures, facial expressions, and posture, while para-linguistic cues refer to voice-related features such as pitch, tone, speed, and pauses. Together, they enhance or weaken the impact of spoken words.

Non-Verbal Features of Speaking:

1. **Facial Expressions** – Use of eyes, eyebrows, and mouth to convey emotions.
2. **Gestures** – Movements of hands and arms to emphasize or clarify spoken words.
3. **Posture** – Body stance that communicates confidence, openness, or defensiveness.
4. **Eye Contact** – Maintaining or avoiding eye contact to show interest, honesty, or discomfort.
5. **Body Movements** – Movements like nodding the head to show agreement or disagreement.
6. **Proxemics** – Use of personal space and distance in communication.
7. **Appearance** – Clothing and grooming that impact how a speaker is perceived.
8. **Physical Contact** – Touching gestures such as handshakes or pats to build rapport.

3. Para-Linguistic Features of Speaking:

Para-linguistic features are the vocal elements of speech—how you say something rather than what you say. They include pitch, tone, volume, pace, pauses, and emphasis, all of which can change the meaning and emotional impact of your words.

1. Pitch – The highness or lowness of the voice.
2. Volume – Loudness or softness of the speech.
3. Rate/Speed – How fast or slow someone speaks.
4. Tone – The emotional quality or attitude conveyed through voice.
5. Pause – Strategic silences used for emphasis or thought.
6. Stress/Emphasis – Highlighting certain words or syllables to change
7. meaning.
8. Intonation – The rise and fall of voice pitch across phrases or sentences.
9. Quality – The unique characteristic or texture of a person's voice (e.g., breathy, nasal, rough).

4. Overcoming Stage Fright

Stage fright is nervousness or anxiety before speaking in public. It can be reduced by practicing aloud, controlling body language, and managing voice modulation to sound clear and confident.

Ways to Overcome Stage Fright:

1. Start with Small Group Presentations- Practice speaking in front of just a few classmates first to build comfort before facing the whole class.
2. Use Simple Warm-Up Exercises- Teach quick warm-ups like humming, tongue twisters, or stretching to relax the voice and body before speaking.
3. Break Down the Speech- Divide your speech into smaller parts or bullet points so it feels less overwhelming.
4. Encourage Peer Support and Feedback- Create a friendly environment where classmates provide positive, constructive feedback to boost confidence.
5. Practice Mindfulness and Breathing Techniques- Do easy breathing exercises to calm nerves, like inhaling deeply for 4 counts and exhaling slowly for 6 counts.
6. Practice Eye Contact with Friendly Faces- Try to focus your gaze on supportive friends or kind faces in the audience to reduce anxiety.
7. Positive Visualization- Imagine yourself speaking clearly and confidently, picturing a successful presentation.
8. Normalize Mistakes- Reassure yourself that small mistakes happen and are normal, and that the audience is usually understanding and supportive.
9. Voice Warm-Up: Reading a paragraph aloud to improve clarity.
10. Rehearsal: Practicing in front of a mirror to check body language.
11. Controlled Gestures: Avoiding fidgeting or pacing too much.

Quiz 1

1. Which speaking mode involves delivering a speech with little to no preparation, often in response to an unexpected request?

- a) Manuscript speaking
- b) Memorized speaking
- c) Extemporaneous speaking
- d) Impromptu speaking

Correct Answer: d) Impromptu speaking.

Impromptu speaking is the delivery of a speech with little or no preparation, requiring the speaker to think on their feet.

2. A news anchor reading a prepared statement from a teleprompter is an example of which speaking mode?

- a) Impromptu speaking
- b) Manuscript speaking
- c) Extemporaneous speaking
- d) Memorized speaking

Correct Answer: b) Manuscript speaking.

Manuscript speaking involves reading a speech word-for-word from a written text, which ensures precision and accuracy, as is required for news broadcasts.

3. What is a key advantage of extemporaneous speaking?

- a) It requires no research or planning.
- b) It guarantees a flawless, word-for-word delivery.
- c) It allows for a natural, conversational tone and audience engagement.
- d) It is the most appropriate mode for highly technical or legal information.

Correct Answer: c) It allows for a natural, conversational tone and audience engagement. Extemporaneous speaking uses a prepared outline, allowing the

speaker to maintain eye contact and adapt to the audience while still having a clear structure.

4. The "Drill" method is a type of memorization most effective for:

- a) Understanding complex, abstract concepts.
- b) Committing a specific sequence of facts or a short list to memory.
- c) Developing a flexible, conversational speaking style.
- d) Creating a well-structured speech outline.

Correct Answer: b) Committing a specific sequence of facts or a short list to memory.

The Drill method relies on repetition and is excellent for learning things like a specific list of terms or a sequence of steps.

5. What is a primary disadvantage of the memorized speaking mode?

- a) It is impossible to use gestures or body language.
- b) It can sound unnatural or rehearsed.
- c) It requires minimal practice.
- d) It limits the speaker's ability to maintain eye contact.

Correct Answer: b) It can sound unnatural or rehearsed.

When a speech is recited from memory, it can often lack the natural inflections and spontaneity of a conversational delivery.

6. Which speaking mode is often used in situations where precise wording is critical, such as a political address or a scientific report?

- a) Impromptu speaking
- b) Memorized speaking
- c) Extemporaneous speaking
- d) Manuscript speaking

Correct Answer: d) Manuscript speaking.

Manuscript speaking ensures that the message is delivered with exact wording and no chance of misstatement, which is crucial in formal and precise contexts.

7. A professor lecturing from a set of note cards or a presentation outline is most likely using which speaking mode?

- a) Impromptu speaking
- b) Reading from a manuscript
- c) Extemporaneous speaking
- d) Memorized speaking

Correct Answer: c) Extemporaneous speaking.

This mode is defined by the use of an outline or notes to guide a conversational, yet structured, delivery.

8. Which of the following is a characteristic of impromptu speaking?

- a) A rigid, formal structure.
- b) A meticulously rehearsed delivery.
- c) The speaker's ability to draw on general knowledge and experience.
- d) A complete, word-for-word script.

Correct Answer: c) The speaker's ability to draw on general knowledge and experience.

Without a prepared script, an impromptu speaker must rely on their existing knowledge base and quick thinking.

9. What is the main difference between extemporaneous and impromptu speaking?

- a) Extemporaneous is always longer than impromptu.
- b) Extemporaneous uses a full script, while impromptu uses notes.
- c) Extemporaneous is planned and outlined, while impromptu is spontaneous.
- d) Extemporaneous requires no practice, while impromptu does.

Correct Answer: c) Extemporaneous is planned and outlined, while impromptu is spontaneous.

The key distinction is the level of preparation; extemporaneous has an outline, while impromptu has none.

10. A poet reciting their own work from memory in front of an audience is using which speaking mode?

- a) Impromptu speaking
- b) Extemporaneous speaking
- c) Memorized speaking
- d) Manuscript speaking

Correct Answer: c) Memorized speaking.

Reciting something from memory, like a poem or a play, is a classic example of the memorized speaking mode.

Quiz 2

1. What is the study of how body movements, gestures, and facial expressions communicate called?

- a) Proxemics
- b) Vocalics
- c) Haptics
- d) Kinesics

Correct Answer: d) Kinesics.

Kinesics is the technical term for the study of communication through body language, including gestures, posture, and facial expressions.

2. A speaker who fidgets with their hands and avoids eye contact is demonstrating a lack of which nonverbal feature?

- a) Vocalics
- b) Body language and posture
- c) Proxemics
- d) Rate

Correct Answer: b) Body language and posture.

Fidgeting and poor eye contact are examples of distracting body language that can undermine a speaker's message and confidence.

3. Which of the following is an example of a paralinguistic feature of a speech?

- a) The speaker's hand gestures.
- b) The speaker's eye contact with the audience.
- c) The speaker's tone of voice.
- d) The speaker's posture.

Correct Answer: c) The speaker's tone of voice.

Paralinguistic features are the vocal elements of speech that are not words themselves, such as tone, pitch, volume, and rate.

4. A speaker who speaks too quickly and uses a lot of "um" or "uh" filler words is struggling with which paralinguistic feature?

- a) Pitch
- b) Volume
- c) Rate and pauses
- d) Articulation

Correct Answer: c) Rate and pauses.

Speaking too fast and using filler words are signs of poor control over the speed and effective use of silence in a speech.

5. The study of how personal space and distance affect communication is known as:

- a) Chronemics
- b) Haptics
- c) Proxemics
- d) Kinesics

Correct Answer: c) Proxemics.

Proxemics is the study of how people use and perceive space in communication, and it deals with concepts like personal and public distance.

6. When a speaker lowers their voice to a whisper to create a dramatic effect, they are manipulating which paralinguistic feature?

- a) Pitch
- b) Articulation
- c) Rate
- d) Volume

Correct Answer: d) Volume.

Volume refers to the loudness or softness of the voice, and changing it for effect is a powerful paralinguistic tool.

7. If someone speaks loudly and quickly, this reflects changes in:

- A) Pronunciation
- B) Volume and pace
- C) Grammar and syntax
- D) Word meaning

Answer: B) Volume and Pace

8. How can a speaker's posture influence their credibility (ethos) with the audience?

- a) Slouching makes the speaker seem more relaxed and relatable.
- b) A rigid posture makes the speaker appear more serious and authoritative.
- c) A confident, open posture with shoulders back signals competence and authority.
- d) Posture has no impact on credibility; only the content matters.

Correct Answer: c) A confident, open posture with shoulders back signals competence and authority. Rationale: An open, confident posture communicates self-assurance and competence, which directly enhances a speaker's credibility.

9. What does a speaker's articulation refer to?

- a) The emotional quality of their voice.
- b) The speed at which they talk.
- c) The clarity and distinctness of the sounds they make.

d) The loudness or softness of their voice.

Correct Answer: c) The clarity and distinctness of the sounds they make. Rationale: Articulation is the physical production of speech sounds, focusing on how clearly and precisely a speaker pronounces words.

10. Paralinguistic features focus mainly on:

A) The meaning of words

B) The way something is said

C) The grammatical structure

D) The written text

Answer: B) The way something is said

1. Which speaking mode demands structured delivery without the use of notes but with prior preparation?

A) Impromptu

B) Extempore

C) Reading

D) Memorizing & Drill

Answer: B) Extempore

Explanation: Extempore speaking involves prepared ideas but spontaneous wording.

2. Speaking without preparation, often in response to an unexpected prompt, is called ____.

- A) Impromptu
- B) Extempore
- C) Reading
- D) Drill

Answer: A) Impromptu

Explanation: Impromptu speaking is unrehearsed and immediate.

3. Which speaking mode can risk monotony if not delivered with vocal variety and eye contact?

- A) Reading
- B) Extempore
- C) Impromptu
- D) Drill

Answer: A) Reading

Explanation: Reading aloud without expression can disengage listeners.

4. Which method relies on repetition to internalize speech patterns?

- A) Extempore
- B) Drill
- C) Reading
- D) Impromptu

Answer: B) Drill

Explanation: Drill emphasizes repetitive practice to reinforce delivery.

5. Which speaking mode often risks sounding mechanical if the speaker over-rehearses?

- A) Impromptu
- B) Extempore
- C) Memorizing & Drill
- D) Reading

Answer: C) Memorizing & Drill

Explanation: Memorization without flexibility may reduce natural expression

6. In nonverbal communication, which feature involves the movement of hands to support verbal messages?

- A) Kinesics
- B) Haptics
- C) Proxemics
- D) Chronemics

Answer: A) Kinesics

Explanation: Kinesics refers to gestures, facial expressions, and body movement.

7. Maintaining an appropriate distance while speaking falls under which nonverbal category?

- A) Chronemics
- B) Proxemics
- C) Oculistics
- D) Paralanguage

Answer: B) Proxemics

Explanation: Proxemics studies spatial distance in interaction.

8. Eye movement and gaze patterns are studied in which nonverbal dimension?

A) Haptics

B) Oculistics

C) Kinesics

D) Paralanguage

Answer: B) Oculistics

Explanation: Oculistics examines eye contact and movement.

9. The study of touch in communication is termed ____.

A) Haptics

B) Kinesics

C) Proxemics

D) Chronemics

Answer: A) Haptics

Explanation: Haptics focuses on tactile interaction in communication.

10. Vocal tone, pitch, and pace fall under which communicative category?

A) Nonverbal

B) Verbal

C) Paralinguistic

D) Kinesics

Answer: C) Paralinguistic

Explanation: Paralinguistic features relate to vocal attributes beyond words.

11. Which paralinguistic feature refers to pauses and hesitations in speech?

A) Timbre

B) Disfluencies

C) Intonation

D) Inflection

Answer: B) Disfluencies

Explanation: Disfluencies include “uh,” “um,” and other hesitation markers.

12. Variations in pitch to convey meaning or emotion are called ____.

A) Modulation

B) Timbre

C) Articulation

D) Volume

Answer: A) Modulation

Explanation: Pitch modulation helps emphasize emotions and key points.

13. Which paralinguistic feature most directly influences clarity of pronunciation?

A) Articulation

B) Timbre

C) Pitch

D) Rate

Answer: A) Articulation

Explanation: Articulation ensures crisp and accurate pronunciation.

14. Which nonverbal feature is most likely to convey cultural identity?

A) Proxemics

B) Clothing and appearance

C) Oculistics

D) Chronemics

Answer: B) Clothing and appearance

Explanation: Dress and grooming often communicate cultural and social messages.

15. In speaking modes, which style is ideal for formal speeches with pre-prepared text?

A) Impromptu

B) Reading

C) Drill

D) Extempore

Answer: B) Reading

Explanation: Reading ensures accuracy in formal contexts like legal or academic speeches.

16. Speaking rate that is excessively fast may negatively affect which paralinguistic quality?

- A) Clarity
- B) Timbre
- C) Pitch
- D) Tone

Answer: A) Clarity

Explanation: Speeding up can cause slurring and reduce comprehension

17. Which nonverbal element regulates conversational flow by signaling when it's another person's turn to speak?

- A) Gestures
- B) Eye contact
- C) Silence
- D) Posture

Answer: B) Eye contact

Explanation: Sustained or withdrawn gaze can cue turn-taking.

18. Which speaking mode best develops quick thinking under pressure?

- A) Reading
- B) Drill
- C) Impromptu
- D) Memorizing

Answer: C) Impromptu

Explanation: Impromptu speaking sharpens spontaneous articulation.

19. Which paralinguistic element gives the speaker's voice its unique quality or "color"?

- A) Pitch
- B) Volume
- C) Timbre
- D) Rate

Answer: C) Timbre

Explanation: Timbre refers to the distinctive tone quality of a voice.

20. Which nonverbal cue can unintentionally signal nervousness or lack of confidence?

- A) Firm posture
- B) Avoiding eye contact
- C) Controlled gestures
- D) Steady breathing

Answer: B) Avoiding eye contact

Explanation: Lack of eye contact may be read as discomfort or insecurity.

Class Test Questions

1. Differentiate between Extempore and Impromptu speaking with suitable classroom or professional examples.
2. Explain Reading as a speaking mode and discuss its advantages and disadvantages in formal communication.
3. Describe Memorizing & Drill as a method of speech preparation. How can it be both helpful and risky for delivery?
4. List and explain any four key nonverbal features of communication observed in an effective public speaker.
5. Discuss the role of gestures and facial expressions in enhancing the impact of spoken messages.
6. What is the importance of eye contact (oculesics) in public speaking? Give two examples where it plays a crucial role?
7. Explain paralinguistic features and discuss how tone, pitch, and pace influence audience perception.
8. Describe the role of articulation and pronunciation in effective speech delivery, with examples from a technical presentation.
9. How can nonverbal cues be used to build credibility during a presentation or interview?
10. Discuss the relationship between nonverbal features and paralinguistic features in making a speech engaging and impactful.